A short reflection on today's Gospel Matthew 21:1-14

In today's Gospel, Jesus compares the Kingdom of Heaven to a wedding banquet prepared by a king. The invitation is generous and freely offered, yet many of those invited choose not to come. Eventually, the invitation is extended to everyone - to people from the roads and crossroads, to those who might never have expected a place at the table.

This is a beautiful reminder of the generosity of God. His invitation is not reserved for a select few. God calls each of us into friendship with him and offers us a place in the joy of his Kingdom. We do not earn this invitation; it is a gift of grace.

Yet the Gospel also reminds us that accepting God's invitation calls for a response. The wedding garment can be understood as a sign of a heart that has been changed by God's love - a life clothed in faith, compassion, forgiveness and charity. It is not enough simply to hear God's invitation; we are called to let it shape the way we live.

Perhaps there are times when we are like those who were too busy or distracted to accept the invitation. The pressures and concerns of daily life can easily push God to the margins. This Gospel invites us to pause, recognise the grace being offered to us, and respond with open and grateful hearts.

As a parish community, may we remember that there is always room at God's table. May we welcome others with the same generosity that God shows us, and may our lives bear witness to the joy of accepting his invitation.

Prayer for Vocations to the Priesthood: We pray that the men called to be priests of our diocese will know the truth of St Paul's words in our second reading, "There is nothing I cannot master with the help of the One who gives me strength."

Are you 18 years or older and thinking or wondering about serving the Church as a priest of the diocese of Derry? There will be an afternoon Talk with time for prayer, discussion, questions & answers in Derry on Sunday 11th October. For further details please contact Fr Pat O'Hagan at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Saint Carlo Acutis Day of Prayer. You are invited to come to St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry today, Sunday 11th October from 2.00pm where we will have Veneration of a First Class Relic of St Carlo Acutis, gifted to the Cathedral by Carlo's mother, Antonia.

The Sacrament of Confession will be available from 2.00pm until Mass at 7.00pm, which will be celebrated by Bishop Michael Router. Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in the Mother Teresa Chapel during the Celebrations. A short film on Carlo's life will be shown in the Conference Room. Everyone is welcome to this special time.

Mass bouquets are available for £2 each as a thanksgiving for the gift of St Carlo Acutis. Bouquets can be purchased from the parish office during the week and after Masses next weekend. St Carlo, known for his deep love of the Eucharist and his inspiring witness of faith in the digital age, is a powerful intercessor for young people, families, and all those seeking to grow in holiness. This is a beautiful way to celebrate this joyful occasion and to share a spiritual gift with someone you love or remember in prayer.

International Exhibition - The Eucharistic Miracles of the World, designed and created by St. Carlo Acutis will take place in The Cathedral Hall, Infirmary Road until 16th October 2026. Come and discover the remarkable stories of Eucharistic miracles from around the world, brought together through the inspiring work of St. Carlo Acutis. Admission is free - all are welcome.

Sympathy

We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of:

Eugene Hillick
James Kelly

May they rest in peace

Anniversaries

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:

Raymond Cassidy
Rose McCaul
Kathleen Bradley
Jim Bradley
Maureen Keys
Robbie Herron
Annie Phelan
John Kelly

May they rest in peace

Baptisms

We welcome as members of God's family:

Lyra Rae Patterson
Dáire Daniel Coyle

To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office 02871 262894

Sacrament of Marriage

We congratulate

Colleen McDevitt & Allan Watt

who celebrated the Sacrament of Marriage recently in the Cathedral

May God bless you abundantly in love, joy and happiness

Collection

Priests Collection: £5,197
Parish Development: £1,076

Thank you for your generosity

Thank you

Fr Farren acknowledges with thanks the following donations for:

SVdP: £60
Flowers for the Altar: £40
Water Aid: £500
Hungry Children: £10, £20, £10
Smile Train: £40, £100, £10
Mary's Meals: £20, £10, £20
Sight Savers: £20, £40
Matt Talbot Prayer Society: £20, £5

Readers for 17th /18th October

6.15pm Mary Morrison
7.30pm Stephen Orr/Karl Orr
9.30am Kate Doherty
11.00am St Anne's PS
12.30pm Marie Canning
7.00pm Anna Begley

Our Lady, Untier of Knots Novena - The Novena to Our Lady, Untier of Knots continues after the 7.30pm Mass on Thursdays, in St Eugene's Cathedral, concluding on Thursday 26th November. This Novena reminds us that sin never entangled Our Lady, and that Christ gave us His Mother as Our Lady, Untier of Knots. Through this devotion, we entrust our personal "knots" to her loving care - learning to let go and allowing her to gently untie what binds us. All are welcome to join in prayer and reflection during this special time of grace.

Would you like to become an Altar Server in St Eugene's Cathedral? We are recruiting for anyone who is in Primary 5 and upwards, to come and serve at our weekend Masses. If you are interested in becoming an altar server, please email Lauren at lauren.doherty@derrydiocese.org or phone the parish office on 02871 262894 for more information.'